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United States Patent	12413858
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
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Electronic device and gain calibration method for image stabilization function thereof

Abstract

The invention provides an electronic device and a gain calibration method for an image stabilization function thereof. The method includes the following. The image stabilization function is activated. A first image is generated by using a first gain through an image capturing device, and a first blur degree of the first image is obtained. A second image is generated by using a second gain through the image capturing device, and a second blur degree of the second image is obtained. A reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain is determined according to the second blur degree. A calibrated gain for the image stabilization function is determined according to a linear relationship established between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain.

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Appl. No.:	18/467743
Filed:	September 15, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240292098 A1	Aug. 29, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

TW	112106576	Feb. 23, 2023
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Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04N23/68 (20230101); H04N17/00 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H04N23/6812 (20230101); H04N17/002 (20130101); H04N23/6811 (20230101); H04N23/683 (20230101); H04N23/687 (20230101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H04N (23/6812); H04N (23/687)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application claims the priority benefit of Taiwan application serial no. 112106576, filed on Feb. 23, 2023. The entirety of the above-mentioned patent application is hereby incorporated by reference herein and made a part of this specification.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(2) The disclosure relates to a gain calibration method for an image stabilization function and an electronic device using the method.

Description of Related Art

(3) With the advancement of technology, electronic apparatuses with image capturing functions have filled the lives of modern people. If the electronic apparatus is in a vibrating or shaking state, there may be afterimages in the captured image, resulting in poor image quality. Therefore, in order

to improve the above problems, an image stabilization function (also known as an anti-shake function or an anti-vibrate function) is developed to improve image quality.

(4) Currently, the image stabilization function needs to apply a gyro gain to compensate the vibration of the electronic apparatus, so as to achieve the image stabilization function. Generally, camera module manufacturers provide preset gyro gains. However, due to factors such as assembly tolerances, mechanical stress, or component characteristic differences, the preset gyro gains provided by the camera module manufacturers are not optimal values that can provide the optimal image stabilization effect for assembled electronic apparatuses. Therefore, before the assembled electronic apparatus leaves the factory, it is generally necessary to calibrate the gyro gain again. Currently, in a traditional calibration process, a global search method is mostly used to find an optimal gyro gain. However, a traditional calibration method needs to test several different gyro gains one by one (for example, 10 gyro gains or more gyro gains), and then may search to get the best gyro gain according to a curve formed by picture capturing results of the different gyro gains. In this case, in order to calibrate gains applicable to respective electronic apparatuses, the traditional calibration process is time-consuming and inefficient.

SUMMARY

(5) The disclosure provides a gain calibration method for an image stabilization function, which is used for an electronic device including an image capturing device, and the gain calibration method includes the following. The image stabilization function is activated. A first image is generated by using a first gain through the image capturing device, and a first blur degree of the first image is obtained. A second image is generated by using a second gain through the image capturing device, and a second blur degree of the second image is obtained. A reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain is determined according to the second blur degree. A calibrated gain for the image stabilization function is determined according to a linear relationship established between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain.

(6) The disclosure also provides an electronic device, which includes an image capturing device and a processor. The processor is coupled to the image capturing device. The processor is configured to perform the following. The image stabilization function is activated. A first image is generated by using a first gain through the image capturing device, and a first blur degree of the first image is obtained. A second image is generated by using a second gain through the image capturing device, and a second blur degree of the second image is obtained. A reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain is determined according to the second blur degree. A calibrated gain for the image stabilization function is determined according to a linear relationship established between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain.

(7) Based on the above, in the embodiment of the disclosure, when the image stabilization function is activated, the first image may be generated based on the first gain, and the second image may be generated based on the second gain. The first blur degree and the second blur degree may be generated respectively according to the first image and the second image. The reference blur degree may be determined according to the second blur degree. Thus, the linear relationship established between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain may be used to determine the calibrated gain. Based on this, not only can the image stabilization effect be ensured to be good, but also the gain calibration efficiency can be greatly improved.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a gain calibration system for an image stabilization function according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram illustrating an electronic device according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a flow chart illustrating a gain calibration method for an image stabilization function according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram illustrating calculating a blur degree according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram illustrating a corresponding relationship between a gyro gain and a pixel shift amount according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram illustrating an optical image stabilization system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(7) Reference will now be made in detail to the exemplary embodiments of the disclosure, examples of the exemplary embodiments are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Wherever possible, the same reference numerals are used in the drawings and descriptions to refer to the same or like parts. These embodiments are only a part of the disclosure, and do not reveal all possible implementations of the disclosure. Rather, these embodiments are merely examples of devices and methods within the scope of the disclosure.

(8) Please refer to FIG. 1. A gain calibration system **10** for an image stabilization function may include an electronic device **100**, a vibration table **P1**, and a test pattern **T1**.

(9) The electronic device **100** may be, for example, a smart phone, a digital camera, a tablet computer, a game console, an electronic wearable device or a photographic device, etc., and various electronic devices with image capturing functions, and a type of the electronic device **100** is not limited thereto. It should be noted that the electronic device **100** has an image stabilization function, which may be an optical image stabilization (OIS) function or an electric image stabilization (EIS) function.

(10) The electronic device **100** is disposed on the vibration table **P1**. The vibration table **P1** may be a vibrating tool table, and is configured to fix the electronic device **100**. The vibration table **P1** may control the electronic device **100** to vibrate at a specific vibration frequency and a vibration angle. For example, to simulate a hand vibration state, the vibration frequency of the vibration table **P1** may be set to 6 Hz. In some embodiments, the test pattern **T1** may be presented on a drawing or carriers of other materials. In some embodiments, the test pattern **T1** may comprise one or more vertical black lines and/or horizontal black lines, but the disclosure is not limited thereto. From another point of view, the test pattern **T1** may be a drawing, a physical object, or a light projection pattern, and the disclosure is not limited thereto. The electronic device **100** on the vibration table **P1** is suitable for capturing an image toward the test pattern **T1**, so as to calibrate a gain for the image stabilization function according to the captured image of the test pattern **T1**.

(11) Referring to FIG. 2, the electronic device **100** may include an image capturing device **110**, a processor **120**, and a sensor **130**.

(12) The image capturing device **110** is configured to capture images or videos, and may include a lens **111**, an image sensing element **112**, and other components. The lens **111** may include an optical lens element to perform light path control. The image sensing element **112** is configured to provide an image sensing function. The image sensing element **112** may include a photosensitive element, such as a charge coupled device (CCD), a complementary metal-oxide semiconductor (CMOS) element or other elements, and the disclosure is not limited thereto. The lens **111** may collect an imaging light on the image sensing element **112** to achieve the purpose of capturing the image. In some embodiments, when the electronic device **100** has the OIS function, the image

capturing device **110** further includes components related to the OIS function, such as a drive unit for controlling a movement of the lens **111** and so on.

(13) The processor **120** is coupled to the image capturing device **110** and the sensor **130**, which is, for example, a central processing unit (CPU), an application processor (AP), or other programmable general-purpose or special-purpose microprocessors, a digital signal processor (DSP), an image signal processor (ISP), a graphics processing unit (GPU), or other similar devices, integrated circuits, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the processor **120** may execute commands or program codes in a memory to implement operations of a gain calibration method in the embodiments of the disclosure. The memory may include a volatile storage circuit and a non-volatile storage circuit.

(14) The sensor **130** may be an inertial sensor, which is configured to sense a vibration and a movement of the electronic device **100**. The sensor **130** may include an accelerometer or a gyro and the like. For example, the sensor **130** may be configured to sense an angular velocity generated by the vibration of the electronic device **100**. A rotation angle and a rotation direction of the electronic device **100** may be calculated through performing integration or other mathematical operations on the angular velocity or a linear acceleration sensed by the sensor **130**. Therefore, the processor **120** may perform the image stabilization function according to sensing data output by the sensor **130**, such as adjusting a position of the lens **111**, adjusting other capturing parameters (such as a shutter speed or an ISO value), or adjusting the captured image by using software algorithms.

(15) FIG. 3 is a flow chart illustrating the gain calibration method for the image stabilization function according to an embodiment of the disclosure. Referring to FIG. 3, the method of this embodiment may be executed by the electronic device **100** shown in FIG. 1 and FIG. 2. The details of each operation in FIG. 3 will be described below with components shown in FIG. 1 and FIG. 2.

(16) In Step S301, the processor **120** activates the image stabilization function. The image stabilization functions include the OIS function, the EIS function, or a combination thereof.

(17) In Step S302, the processor **120** generates a first image by using a first gain through the image capturing device **110**, and obtains a first blur degree of the first image. Next, in Step S303, the processor **120** generates a second image by using a second gain through the image capturing device **110**, and obtains a second blur degree of the second image.

(18) Specifically, when the image capturing device **110** is in a vibration state and the image stabilization function is activated, the processor **120** sequentially generates the first image and the second image respectively by using the first gain and the second gain through the image capturing device **110**. In detail, when the image stabilization function is activated, the first gain and the second gain may respectively be used to adjust the sensing data output by the sensor **130**. In some embodiments, the first gain includes a first gyro gain, and the second gain includes a second gyro gain. That is to say, the first gain and the second gain may also be referred to as angular velocity gains. In some embodiments, the angular velocity gain may be used to amplify or reduce an angular velocity output by the sensor **130**, so that the processor **130** may perform the image stabilization function according to an angular velocity adjusted by the angular velocity gain.

(19) In some embodiments, the processor **120** may determine the first gain and the second gain according to a preset gain. The preset gain is between the first gain and the second gain. The preset gain may be recorded in a storage device of the electronic device **100**. For example, the preset gain may be a preset value pre-programmed by a manufacturer of the image capturing device **110** into a storage circuit in the image capturing device **110**.

(20) In some embodiments, the processor **120** may add a first positive number to the preset gain to obtain the first gain, and subtract a second positive number from the preset gain to obtain the second gain. In some embodiments, the processor **120** may subtract the first positive number from the preset gain to obtain the first gain, and add the preset gain to the second positive number to obtain the second gain. It should be noted that the first positive number may be different from or the same as the second positive number.

(21) In addition, the processor **120** calculates the first blur degree of the first image and the second blur degree of the second image respectively. The processor **120** may obtain the first blur degree and the second blur degree according to imaging states of the test pattern **T1** in the first image and the second image respectively. In some embodiments, the processor **120** may obtain the first blur degree according to an imaging size (such as a line width, a circle diameter, or a rectangle side length) of the test pattern **T1** in the first image, and obtain the second blur degree according to an imaging size of the test pattern **T1** in the second image. It may be known that the lower the blur degree of the captured image, the better the image stabilization effect.

(22) In some embodiments, the first blur degree includes a first pixel shift amount, and the second blur degree includes a second pixel shift amount. In detail, the processor **120** may obtain the first pixel shift amount according to a contour displacement degree of the test pattern **T1** in the first image, and obtain the second pixel shift amount according to a contour displacement degree of the test pattern **T1** in the second image.

(23) For example, referring to FIG. 4, the test pattern **T1** includes a vertical black line as an example for illustration, but the disclosure is not limited thereto. When the image capturing device **110** is in the vibration state and the image stabilization function is activated, the processor **120** captures a first image **40** through the image capturing device **110** by using the first gain. In response to the vibration of the image capturing device **110**, a gray area **Z1** appears in an imaging of the test pattern **T1** in the first image **40**. The processor **120** may calculate a distance between a left boundary **B1** and a right boundary **B2** of the gray area **Z1** to obtain a first pixel shift amount ΔS (unit: pixel). In addition, the processor **120** may also calculate the second pixel shift amount based on the second image in the same manner.

(24) Next, in Step **S304**, the processor **120** determines a reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain according to the second blur degree. It should be noted that the first blur degree and the second blur degree calculated by the processor **120** may both be values greater than 0. In some embodiments, the reference blur degree may be a negative number, and an absolute value of the reference blur degree is equal to the second blur degree. For example, if the second blur degree is “10”, then the reference blur degree may be “-10”. Alternatively, in some embodiments, the reference blur degree is a negative number, and a difference between the absolute value of the reference blur degree and the second blur degree is smaller than a tolerance value. In some embodiments, the first gain may be greater than the second gain. Alternatively, in other embodiments, the second gain may be greater than the first gain.

(25) In Step **S305**, the processor **120** determines a calibrated gain for the image stabilization function according to a linear relationship established between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain. Specifically, the gain for the image stabilization function has a linear relationship with a blur degree of the captured image within a certain value range. Based on this feature, the processor **120** may estimate a calibrated gain corresponding to a minimum blur level (e.g., 0) according to a connection line between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain.

(26) In some embodiments, the processor **120** may generate a linear function according to the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain. A slope of the linear function may be positive or negative. Afterward, the processor **120** obtains the calibrated gain for the image stabilization function according to an intersection point of the linear function and a constant function. In some embodiments, a constant of the constant function is 0. That is, the processor **120** may obtain the calibrated gain according to the connection line and an intersection point of an axis (e.g., an X-axis) between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain.

(27) In some embodiments, the processor **120** may record the calibrated gain in the storage device. The storage device is, for example, an electronically erasable rewritable read-only memory

(EEPROM) connected to an image signal processor (ISP), but the disclosure is not limited thereto. That is to say, after completing the gain calibration for the image stabilization function, the processor **120** may perform the image stabilization function according to the calibrated gain in the storage device, so as to compensate for the vibration of the electronic device **100** and generate a clear image.

(28) It should be noted that, the above-mentioned embodiment is illustrated by taking the processor **120** to execute the operations in FIG. **3** as an example, but each operation in FIG. **3** may also be implemented as multiple program codes or circuits, and the disclosure is not limited thereto.

(29) In addition, in order to make the concept of the disclosure more comprehensible, the following description will be supplemented with FIG. **5**. However, FIG. **5** is only an example for illustrating the disclosure, and is not intended to limit the disclosure. It should be noted that, FIG. **5** is illustrated by taking the first gain, the second gain, and the calibrated gain as the gyro gains respectively, and the blur degree as the pixel shift amount. Please refer to FIG. **5**, which is a schematic diagram illustrating a corresponding relationship between the gyro gain and the pixel shift amount according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

(30) It should be noted that, if a traditional calibration process is performed, it is necessary to measure or calculate multiple pixel shift amounts for multiple gyro gains one by one, so as to obtain multiple points as shown in FIG. **5** (such as point A, point B, point C and other points without reference numerals). Observing these points, we may know that a gyro gain value used for the image stabilization function has a positive linear relationship and a negative linear relationship with the pixel shift amount of the captured image within a specific value range. Based on this feature, the processor **120** may obtain a calibrated gyro gain according to the following description.

(31) When the image capturing device **110** is in the vibration state and the image stabilization function is activated, the processor **120** captures the first image by using a first gyro gain “G1” through the image capturing device **110**, and obtains a first pixel shift amount “S1” corresponding to the first gyro gain “G1”. That is, the processor **120** may obtain a point A whose coordinate position is (G1, S1).

(32) In addition, when the image capturing device **110** is in the vibration state and the image stabilization function is activated, the processor **120** captures the second image by using a second gyro gain “G2” through the image capturing device **110**, and obtains a second pixel shift amount “S2” corresponding to the second gyro gain “G2”. That is, the processor **120** may obtain a point B whose coordinate position is (G2, S2). Afterward, the processor **120** may obtain a reference pixel shift amount “-S2” according to the second pixel shift amount “S2”, so as to obtain the reference pixel shift amount “-S2” corresponding to the second gyro gain “G2”. That is, the processor **120** may obtain a point B’ symmetrical to the point B of the X-axis. A coordinate position of the point B’ is (G2, -S2). Afterward, the processor **120** may obtain a calibrated gyro gain “Gc” according to an intersection point of a connection line L1 between the point A and the point B’ and the X-axis.

(33) It should be added that FIG. **5** uses an example where the second gain (i.e., the second gyro gain “G2”) is greater than the first gain (i.e., the first gyro gain “G1”) for illustration. However, in other embodiments, the second gain may be smaller than the first gain, which also belongs to the protection scope of the disclosure. Persons skilled in the art should be able to deduce the embodiment in which the second gain is smaller than the first gain by themselves after referring to the above explanations, so details will not be repeated here.

(34) It may be seen that compared with the traditional global search method that requires a large number of gyro gains to search for the best gyro gain, the number of gyro gains that need to be tested in the embodiment of the disclosure is greatly reduced, thus greatly reducing the time required for the gain calibration process for the image stabilization function.

(35) In some embodiments, the calibrated gain may be used for the OIS function. In another embodiment, the calibrated gain may be used for the EIS function. The calibrated gain may be used to match a sensing value output by the sensor **130** to determine a vibration amplitude of the image

capturing device **110**. Therefore, the processor **120** may perform the OIS function or the EIS function according to the vibration amplitude of the image capturing device **110** to generate the clear image.

(36) Referring to FIG. 6, a drive unit **113** is connected to the lens **111** to move the lens **111** according to a control signal received from the processor **120**. A change of the position of the lens **111** may be detected by a position sensor **114** accordingly. In some embodiments, the position sensor **114** may be implemented by one or more hall elements. The image captured by the image capturing device **110** may be kept stable under various motion states such as hand vibration, head shaking, and vehicle vibration by controlling the drive unit **113** to adjust the position of the lens **111** in different axes. In this way, the OIS function may be realized through the cooperation of the processor **120**, the sensor **130**, and the drive unit **113**. The drive unit **113** is, for example, a voice coil motor or a micro electro-mechanical system (MEMS) or the like.

(37) More specifically, the storage device **140** may record the calibrated gain generated according to the content of the above-mentioned embodiments. The sensor **130** may output the sensing data to the processor **120**, and the processor **120** may use the calibrated gain to adjust the sensing data. Afterward, the processor **120** may calculate a compensation movement amount of the lens **111** in different axes according to adjusted sensing data. Therefore, the processor **120** may control the drive unit **113** to adjust the positions of the lens **111** in different axes according to the compensation movement amount, so as to realize the vibration compensation, thereby alleviating the image blur caused by the vibration.

(38) In summary, in the embodiment of the disclosure, when the image stabilization function is activated, the calibrated gain may be determined by using the image blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the image blur degree corresponding to the second gain. In this way, the calibrated gain may be used to obtain a good image stabilization effect, thereby improving the image quality. In addition, the operation steps of the gain calibration for the image stabilization function can be greatly simplified, thereby the gain calibration efficiency is greatly improved.

(39) Although the disclosure has been described above with embodiments, the embodiments are not intended to limit the disclosure. Persons with ordinary knowledge in the technical field may make some modifications and modifications without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure. The scope of protection of the disclosure should be defined by the appended claims.

Claims

1. A gain calibration method for an image stabilization function is used for an electronic device comprising an image capturing device, the method comprising: activating the image stabilization function; generating a first image by using a first gain through the image capturing device, and obtaining a first blur degree of the first image; generating a second image by using a second gain through the image capturing device, and obtaining a second blur degree of the second image, wherein the first blur degree comprises a first pixel shift amount, and the second blur degree comprises a second pixel shift amount; determining a reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain according to the second blur degree; and determining a calibrated gain for the image stabilization function according to a linear relationship established between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain.
2. The gain calibration method for the image stabilization function according to claim 1, wherein the reference blur degree is a negative number, and an absolute value of the reference blur degree is equal to the second blur degree.
3. The gain calibration method for the image stabilization function according to claim 1, further comprising: determining the first gain and the second gain according to a preset gain, wherein the preset gain is between the first gain and the second gain.
4. The gain calibration method for the image stabilization function according to claim 1, wherein

- determining the calibrated gain for the image stabilization function according to the linear relationship established between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain comprises: generating a linear function according to the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain; and obtaining the calibrated gain for the image stabilization function according to an intersection point of the linear function and a constant function.
5. The gain calibration method for the image stabilization function according to claim 4, wherein a constant of the constant function is 0.
 6. The gain calibration method for the image stabilization function according to claim 1, further comprising: recording the calibrated gain in a storage device.
 7. The gain calibration method for the image stabilization function according to claim 1, wherein the image stabilization function comprises an optical image stabilization (OIS) function or an electric image stabilization (EIS) function.
 8. An electronic device, comprising: an image capturing device; and a processor coupled to the image capturing device and configured to: activate an image stabilization function; generate a first image by using a first gain through the image capturing device, and obtain a first blur degree of the first image; generate a second image by using a second gain through the image capturing device, and obtain a second blur degree of the second image, wherein the first blur degree comprises a first pixel shift amount, and the second blur degree comprises a second pixel shift amount; determine a reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain according to the second blur degree; and determine a calibrated gain for the image stabilization function according to a linear relationship established between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain.
 9. The electronic device according to claim 8, wherein the reference blur degree is a negative number, and an absolute value of the reference blur degree is equal to the second blur degree.
 10. The electronic device according to claim 8, wherein the processor is further configured to: determine the first gain and the second gain according to a preset gain, wherein the preset gain is between the first gain and the second gain.
 11. The electronic device according to claim 8, wherein the processor is further configured to: generate a linear function according to the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain; and obtain the calibrated gain for the image stabilization function according to an intersection point of the linear function and a constant function.
 12. The electronic device according to claim 11, wherein a constant of the constant function is 0.
 13. The electronic device according to claim 8, wherein the processor is further configured to: record the calibrated gain in a storage device.
 14. The electronic device according to claim 8, wherein the image stabilization function comprises an optical image stabilization (OIS) function or an electric image stabilization (EIS) function.
 15. An electronic device, comprising: an image capturing device; and a processor coupled to the image capturing device and configured to: activate an image stabilization function; generate a first image by using a first gain through the image capturing device, and obtain a first blur degree of the first image; generate a second image by using a second gain through the image capturing device, and obtain a second blur degree of the second image; determine a reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain according to the second blur degree, wherein the reference blur degree is a negative number, and an absolute value of the reference blur degree is equal to the second blur degree; and determine a calibrated gain for the image stabilization function according to a linear relationship established between the first blur degree corresponding to the first gain and the reference blur degree corresponding to the second gain.
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